

An always up-to-date guide to Digital Open Badges

What they are, where they came from and how to make them

From the people who developed the global Digital Open Badges standard and created the concept of Badge Pathways

Purpose

NOTE: this is a place to gather content for a We Are Open e-book on Open Badges.

- Perhaps one of the things we need to decide is what we call them!
 - The “Open Badges” twitter hashtag is used far less than the “Digital Badges” hashtag. Some use “Digital Open Badges”
- To gather, structure, and possibly update old blog posts and images by Laura, Doug and Bryan on badges. Decisions can then be made about how to format for an e-book

Content

History

- [Open Badges reaches v1.0!](#) (DB blog. 2013)
- [Webmaker badges are GO!](#) (DB blog. 2012)
- [What we're up to with Mozilla Webmaker \(Open\) badges.](#) (DB blog. 2012)
- [Being loud about badges](#) (LH blog 2011)
- [Assessing Learning](#) (LH blog 2011)
- [Game Mechanics and Participation](#) (LH blog 2011)
- [What did we learn during a 'semester of learning' on #openbadges over at P2PU.org?](#) (DB blog. 2012)
- [Semester of Learning: Open Badges and assessment](#) (DB blog. 2011)
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What are they?

- [What are Open Badges?](#) (GH blog. 2012)
- [Why I would like to use Open Badges for Assessment](#) (GH blog. 2012)
- Unpublished draft from DMe days that C&G didn't get permissions together to allow publication. But perhaps some useful stats to draw on [Exploring learner and](#)

[employer perceptions of Open Badges in supporting young, unemployed people into education, employment or training](#)

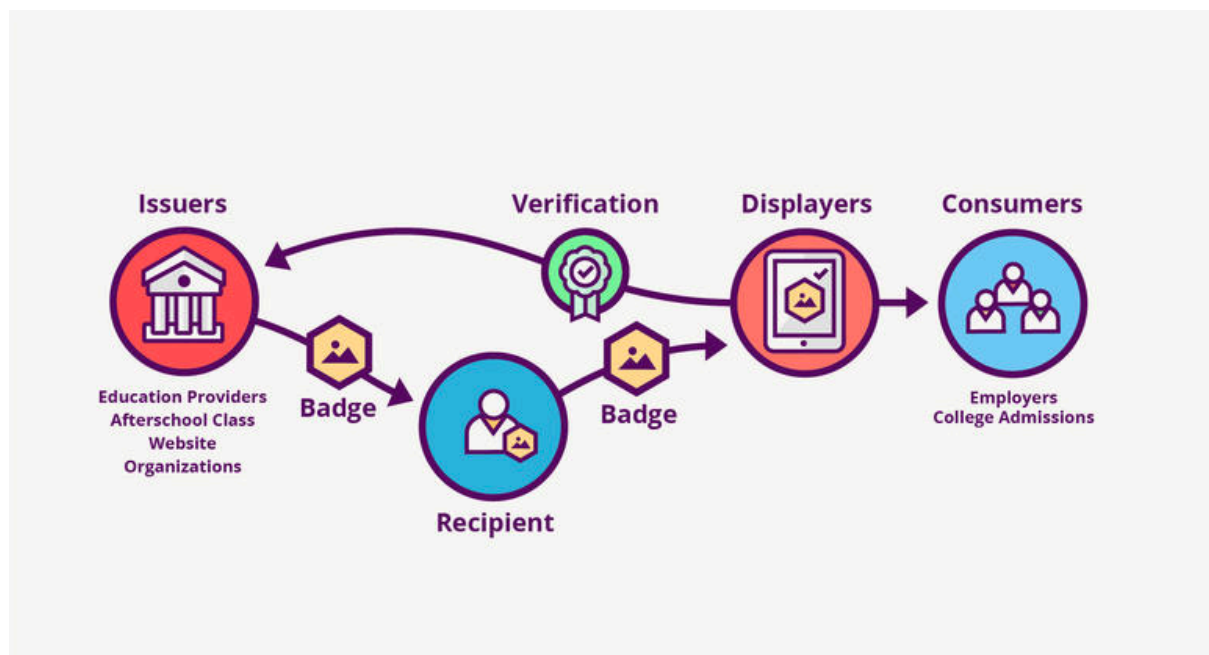
- [What do we mean by recognition?](#) Exploring this concept as part of our Thinkathon process... (GH blog. 2018)
- [Skilling me softly](#) (GH blog. 2015)
- [Creating a Culture of Openness - Pilots to Policy to Prosperity](#) (GH blog. 2015)
- [Developing a new learning currency with Open Badges](#) - ALT webinar (GH blog. 2015)
- [Evidencing Employability Skills with Open Badges](#) (GH blog. 2014)
- [Competency-Based Education and Open Badges](#) (GH blog. 2014)
- [Connecting, Sharing and Caring with Open Badges](#) (GH blog. 2014)
- [The role of badging for recognising skills, abilities and learning - OU Symposium June 2014](#) (GH Slideshare, 2014)
- [Open Badges - Crossover Edinburgh June 2014](#) (GH Slideshare, 2014)
- [Open Badges at the Mozilla Summit 2013](#) (GH blog. 2013)
- [Some thoughts on the evidence behind Open Badges](#) (DB blog. 2016)
- [What is a 'credential' anyway?](#) (DB blog. 2016)

Key initiatives

- [Open Badges in Scottish Education Group \(OBSEG\)](#) (GH blog. 2013)

Future / Trends

- [Open Badges in 2020](#). What's next, based on distance travelled in 2019? (GH blog. 2020)
- [7 trends I spotted in Open Badges in 2019](#) A retrospective on developments over the course of last year (GH blog. 2020)
- [Horizon Higher Education Report 2015 and Badges](#) (GH blog. 2015)
- [Providing some clarity on Open Badges 2.0](#) (DB blog. 2017)
- [Some thoughts on the future of the Open Badges backpack](#) (DB blog. 2017)
- [Open Badges in Higher Education: Disruptive, Desirable, and Democratic](#) (DB blog. 2016)
- [Why do we hire based on 'experience'? HR, Automatic, and Open Badges](#) (DB blog. 2016)
- [Why the future remains bright for Open Badges](#) (DB blog. 2015)
- [Peering Deep into Future of Educational Credentialing \[DMLcentral\]](#) (DB blog. 2015)
- [Open Badges: 3D printing for credentials?](#) (DB blog. 2015)
- [Why I still believe in badges \[DMLcentral\]](#) (DB blog. 2014)
- [What's new with Open Badges?](#) (DB blog. 2014)
- [3 things we need for the next big frontier in Open Badges and digital credentials](#) (DB blog. 2016)



How to make them

- [Getting started with open badges and open microcredentials](#) (2020).
- [Key lessons for creating effective digital credential projects](#) (GH blog. 2019)
- [Quality considerations in Open Badge initiatives](#) (GH blog. 2016)
- [Quality and Open Badges](#) (GH Slideshare, 2016)
- [Open Badge Design Toolkits](#) (GH blog. 2015)
- [Jisc Open Badges Design Toolkit](#) (GH Slideshare, 2015)
- [Developing the series, content and brand design for Jisc RSC Scotland #openbadges](#) (GH blog. 2013)
- [#Openbadges at #MozFest, surfacing and rewarding contribution in an online community](#) (GH blog. 2012)
- [\(Open\) Badging courses created by the community](#) (GH blog. 2012)
- [#OpenBadges: challenges and opportunities for assessment](#) (GH blog. 2012)
- [Towards a visual hierarchy of Open Badges](#) (DB blog. 2015)
- [Towards a taxonomy of Open Badges for City & Guilds](#) (DB blog. 2015)
- [Minimum Viable Badge](#) (DB blog. 2013)
- [How to make #openbadges work for you and your organisation.](#) (DB blog. 2012)
- [Informal learning, gaming, and #openbadges design](#) (DB blog. 2012)
- [Identifying, scaffolding, and credentialing skills in an ever-changing digital environment \[#celt15\]](#) (DB blog. 2015)

Badge Pathways

- [Discovering pathways](#) (GH blog. 2014)
- [Career Discovery - Horizon Scanning and Possible Selves](#) (GH blog. 2014)

- [Building skills-awareness, resilience and pathways to employment using Open Badges](#) Part 1 of a badge-based pathways to employment series (GH blog. 2016)
- Unpublished draft from 4 years ago: [4 approaches to evidence employability skills in a school context using Open Badges – data, peer, teacher and self](#). Part 2 of a Badge-based pathways to employment series (GH blog. 2016)
- [Learning, Badging, Connecting: Mapping your MozFest Learning Journey](#) Learning happens everywhere, but it isn't always recognised in a way that can be shared with others (GH blog. 2015)
- [Ignoring the Instructions and the Learning Comfort Blanket](#) (GH blog. 2014)
- [Open Thinking, Open Learning - D14 May 2014](#) (GH Slideshare, 2014)
- [Badges, Proof and Pathways \[DML Central\]](#) (DB blog. 2017)
- [Tetris, badges, and learning pathways](#) (DB blog. 2015)

Badges for Lifelong Learning (or Cities of Learning?)

- [Open Badges, MOOCs and Recognising Lifelong Learning](#) (GH blog. 2012)
- [A Glasgow City of Learning?](#) 6 considerations for adopting a technology-enabled approach to enhancing lifelong learning, and access to enrichment opportunities, across a city (GH blog. 2018)
- [How can technology help a city raise attainment?](#) A synthesis of place-based, technology-enhanced approaches (GH blog. 2018)
- [Raising attainment through place based, technology-enhanced approaches](#) (GH Slideshare, 2018)
- [Thinking of becoming a Learning City?](#) Some lessons I've learned in supporting this approach... (GH blog. 2018)
- [Lessons Learned from helping cities become Learning Cities](#) (GH Slideshare, 2018)

Politics

- [What we need is an Open Badges community renaissance, free of IMS involvement](#) (DB blog. 2019)
- [Pearson, WTF? Badges, patents, and the world's 'least popular' education company](#) (DB blog. 2017)
- [An exciting week for Open Badges](#) (DB blog. 2015)
- [Badges: talking at cross purposes?](#) (DB blog. 2012)
- [Responding to some criticisms about 'badges' for lifelong learning](#) (DB blog. 2012)
- ['Badges' for Lifelong Learning: Reframing the Debate \(#openbadges, #dmlbadges\)](#) (DB blog. 2012)
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Tech

- [What a post-Persona landscape means for Open Badges](#) (DB blog. 2016)
- [3 reasons open source needs Open Badges \[opensource.com\]](#) (DB blog. 2015)
- [Open Badges location extension](#) (DB blog. 2015)
- [The potential of Chirp.io to send Open Badges between people and devices](#) (DB blog. 2015)
- [Extending Badges \[DMLcentral\]](#) (DB blog. 2015)
- [Getting up to speed on the technical side of #openbadges](#) (DB blog. 2012)
- [Of Bitcoin and Badges.](#) (DB blog. 2012)
- [Open Badges, BlockCerts, and high-stakes credentialing](#) (DB blog. 2016)

Criticism

- [The three biggest \(perceived\) problems with Open Badges](#) (DB blog. 2015)

Misc.

- [New Open Badges napkin sketch](#) (DB blog. 2013)
- [Explaining Open Badges through analogy](#) (DB blog. 2013)
- [Answering your questions about Open Badges](#) (DB blog. 2013)
- [On the 'openness' of Open Badges.](#) (DB blog. 2012)
- [Open Badges, Clay Shirky, and the tipping point.](#) (DB blog. 2012)
- [#OpenBadges through the rear-view mirror?](#) (DB blog. 2012)
- [Gaining Some Perspective on Badges for Lifelong Learning \[DMLcentral\]](#) (DB blog. 2012)
- [If not now, when? Why we need #openbadges and #dmlbadges for lifelong learning RIGHT NOW.](#) (DB blog. 2012)
- [#openbadges – Learner Stories](#) (DB blog. 2011)
- [Against mass consumption of 'already certified' credentials](#) (DB blog. 2015)
- [Notes on ACE's 'Quality Dimensions for Connected Credentials'](#) (DB blog. 2016)
- [Taking Another Look at the Digital Credentials Landscape \[DMLcentral\]](#) (DB blog. 2016)
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